



## UNITED FRONT

**INDIA'S UNOFFICIAL FIRST** family steps out, in sync, in step. Fresh from the Congress's victory in the Lok Sabha polls, Congress President Sonia Gandhi, son Rahul, daughter Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and son-in-law Robert Vadra arrive together at Veer Bhumi to pay homage at the samadhi of Rajiv Gandhi on his 18th death anniversary.

## KOLKATA | Didi Express

The city of joy rarely needs reason to break into celebrations, so Mamata Banerjee's anointment as railways minister was duly feted with typical enthusiasm. A small club in Behala, a part of her constituency, erected a colourful cardboard tableau of a train with 'The Ma-Mati-Manush Express' written on it, inspired by Banerjee's latest slogan. The minister's Kalighat residence was swarming with people waiting to congratulate her and Mamata had to issue an appeal to her supporters to curb their enthusiasm. "Please do not damage my small house," she was heard saying. Kalighat temple authorities announced a record number of pujas and yagnas for the new Trinamool minister. An old lady at the Mamata home revealed that a young man had offered puja on her behalf. She herself had turned up to give Mamata her prasad personally. *by Abhijit Dasgupta*



**A TABLEAU TURNS UP IN MAMATA'S CONSTITUENCY; LOCAL TEMPLES ANNOUNCE RECORD PUJAS AND YAGNAS**